



TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

Sierra Leone: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-17

Edition of 2026-08-17 • 70 systems and instruments tracked, 11 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-17 from the Data Landscapers source base. Sections follow the status report. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.

Of 70 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 35 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-17, 15 did not, 9 carry no stated baseline, and 11 are **Not held** at both ends.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 58 sources for this place in the window — 13 in the earlier half (2025-10 to 2026-02), 45 in the later (2026-03 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced*, *slipped*.

Summary of the period

Over the twelve months to 9 August 2026 Sierra Leone added physical and institutional capacity and left the rules governing it where they were. Two data centres entered service, a second payments generation was contracted, an identity partnership was signed and a first national artificial intelligence strategy went into drafting. No data-protection statute was enacted, no rule allocating loss for mobile-money fraud was made, and the Electronic Transactions Act that has been in force since December 2019 was still being prepared for use. The shape check above is the qualification on all of it: the earlier half of the window holds 13 sources against 44 in the later half, so most of what is recorded as movement was recorded late in the period.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
CSquared West Africa backbone and 2Africa West capacity	Backbone reaching Sierra Leone with no independent 2Africa route (2025-07)	2Africa West capacity added, giving automated rerouting across physically diverse paths (2026-07)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
National fibre backbone (SALCAB)	International capacity reported at 500+ Gbps after the SALCAB privatisation, up from 90 Gbps; no district count published (2025-07)	Fibre in 14 of 16 districts against about US\$400m invested in telecoms, with a 60% usage gap (2026-05)	ADVANCED, MARGINAL
Sierratel relaunch as an MVNO	State telco carrying about US\$6.3m in employee obligations and about US\$35m external debt after failed privatisations, with no partner (2025-07)	Revenue-share MVNO model agreed with Africell, which held 54.51% market share at end-2024; no relaunch date published (2026-04)	ADVANCED
Starlink connectivity for 300 government health facilities	Did not exist	One of 300 facilities connected; cost, funder, procurement route, contract term and data-residency arrangement all unpublished (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Starlink licensed satellite service	Licensed and operating; 12 universities connected through ELCOME SL (2025-01)	Two years licensed with three resellers, and the state buying it for health facilities (2026)	ADVANCED
Second submarine cable landing	Feasibility assessment under way, no landing party or route (2025-07)	Still at feasibility, with a US\$15m investment cited at 2026 stakeholder meetings; no route, landing party or date published	NO CHANGE
SOGEB-Leonecom fibre interconnection at Pamelap	Interconnected at 42.5 Gbps under the Guinea-Sierra Leone Digital Pact 2024 (2025-06)	42.5 Gbps, with 100 Gbps stated for 2026; no upgrade confirmed on the record	NO CHANGE
Spectrum licensing and management framework	BASELINE NOT HELD	Regulator seeking 15-20-year licences, staggered spectrum fees, NGSO guidelines and an automated spectrum management system; none adopted on the record (2026-03)	Baseline not held

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
National Data Centre at NatCA headquarters	Ten-storey building under construction since 2015, not commissioned (2025-07)	Commissioned, housing the National Data Centre and network operations and co-locating NaTCA with MoCTI (2026-04)	ADVANCED
Orange Bo backup data centre	Did not exist; one commercial data centre in Freetown (2018)	EUR 23m disaster-recovery replica of the Freetown facility in service, alongside a US\$50m network modernisation (2025-11)	ADVANCED
NCRA Tier III data centre	BASELINE NOT HELD	Reported as Tier III-compliant and carrying the national biometric register; no certification document held (2026-08)	Baseline not held

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
NaTCA consumer education campaign on online fraud	Did not exist	Advisory campaign running; no rule-making, SIM-swap control, operator obligation or complaint remedy announced alongside it (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Regulator response to the 2026 cybersecurity incidents	Did not exist	Coordinated response announced with no attribution, no named affected service, no incident count, no start date and no severity assessment (2026-07)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Cyber Security and Crime Act 2021	In force (2025-07)	In force and unamended; no prosecution under it is reported in the base (2026-07)	NO CHANGE
National Cyber Security Coordination Centre (NC3)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Operating and named in the government's fraud response; no founding instrument, mandate or budget held (2026-08)	Baseline not held

The two additions that changed the country's physical position both opened in the period. Orange [opened a EUR 23m disaster-recovery replica of its Freetown facility in Bo on 29 November 2025](#), and the state [commissioned the National Data Centre at the NaTCA headquarters on 17 April 2026](#) after a build begun in 2015. Both were framed by their principals as resilience and custody rather than capacity, and neither party publishes rack count, load or utilisation.

The backbone moved little and was measured for the first time: [fibre in 14 of 16 districts against about US\\$400m invested, with a 60% usage gap](#) as at May 2026. The [Pamelap interconnection with Guinea stayed at 42.5 Gbps with the 100 Gbps stated for 2026 unconfirmed](#), and the [second submarine landing did not move past feasibility](#). Redundancy that did arrive came from a wholesale carrier rather than from national investment, when [CSquared added 2Africa West capacity to the backbone reaching the country in July 2026](#).

The state telco found a route out of its balance sheet without capital: Africell was [appointed investment partner for a revenue-share MVNO relaunch in April 2026](#), with no relaunch date published.

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Government Service Bus and X-Road data exchange layer	World Bank terms of reference for an open-source prototype in the Ministry of Finance data centre; nothing running (2025)	Data Exchange Layer piloting on X-Road under the Ministry of Finance; no production date, connected agencies or governance rules published (2026-08)	ADVANCED

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
MOSIP migration of the national identity system	Brownfield migration of enrolled records onto open-source MOSIP, piloted from early 2024 (2025-07)	Pilot complete and full implementation unfunded, as stated by the Authority (2026-08)	ADVANCED, UNFUNDED
National digital identity platform (Bhutan NDI and SIGN Foundation)	A bilateral blockchain digital-identity memorandum with Sign and nothing built (2025-11)	Tri-party memorandum signed June 2026, MOSIP-based register with W3C verifiable credentials specified, and consultations opened; no framework, legal instrument or timetable published (2026-08)	ADVANCED
SIM registration linked to the National Identification Number	Did not exist as an enforced link (2025-07)	Named as the government's principal enforcement lever against mobile-money fraud while not all subscribers have a verified NIN linked (2026-08)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
National Identification Number and biometric identity register	93% registration coverage reported, 6.4m NIN holders against an 8.8m target (2025-06)	About 93% coverage with a unique NIN each, backed by a Tier III data centre and a live eKYC platform (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
National identity card issuance	Under 0.5m cards issued against 6.4m NIN holders, at a fee of US\$6-7 (2024)	No issuance figure published since 2024	NO CHANGE

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Afrimoney prepaid Visa card (Africell, with Ecobank)	Did not exist	Prepaid card in service, issued against the Afrimoney wallet (2026-05)	ADVANCED
Flot payments platform and chatbot (Open Hub)	Did not exist	In service with multi-channel card and mobile-money acceptance and a no-code store builder (2026-04)	ADVANCED
MikashBoks Interest Plus savings product (with Ecobank)	Did not exist	In service, deposits held in an Ecobank master account, 80% UK-investor funded (2025-11)	ADVANCED
Orange Money virtual Mastercard (with Zenith Bank)	Did not exist	Virtual card in service for online, international and cross-border payments (2026-03)	ADVANCED
National instant payment switch	Live with seven banks and two mobile operators (2025-04)	In service; no transaction volume, participant count or availability figure published for 2026	NO CHANGE
Mobile-money fraud complaints logged by Orange Sierra Leone	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 390 complaints in 2026 to date (2026-08)	Baseline not held
Police requests for subscriber KYC data answered by Orange Sierra Leone	BASELINE NOT HELD	More than 18,000 requests answered in 2026 to date, which the ministry states are not all cybercrime-related (2026-08)	Baseline not held
Vult multi-currency wallet and card (Velmie, Metro Cable)	BASELINE NOT HELD	In service; no user, merchant or volume figure published since launch (2026)	Baseline not held

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
National Digital Farmer Registry	Integration with the national identity system agreed under Feed Salone (2025-05)	No enrolment figure, launch or completion date published since (2026-08)	NO CHANGE

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Digital health information system and electronic medical records	Paper-based patient records, with no national electronic medical record programme on file (2025-07)	Programme announced covering electronic medical records, disease surveillance and telemedicine across 300 facilities, beginning with one (2026-07)	ADVANCED

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Electronic government procurement platform	No e-procurement programme on record (2025-07)	Study tour to Liberia completed and bilateral cooperation on digital transformation and procurement transparency deepened with the Liberian regulator, reported 2026-08-12; no platform, procurement decision or timetable is published	ADVANCED, MARGINAL
Digitisation of government services	80% of services reported digitised (2025-06)	No later figure published; the 2024 UN e-government ranking of 172 of 193 is the only external measure held	NO CHANGE

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Coordination and Visualization Platform (DSTI with Catholic Relief Services)	Did not exist	Platform launched with a spatial data science workshop for 60 officials covering hazard mapping and inter-agency data governance (2026-07)	ADVANCED
National base map (DSTI with JICA and Aero Toyota)	Did not exist	Phase one covering Western Area Urban District, built on OpenStreetMap with Japanese technical direction; no cost, timetable, hosting arrangement or data licence stated (2026-08)	ADVANCED

Identity gained specification and lost none of its ambiguity. The register itself did not move — [about 93% coverage was reported in June 2025 and again in August 2026](#) — while the ministry signed a [tri-party memorandum with Bhutan's National Digital Identity and the SIGN Foundation in June 2026](#) and settled its specifications in August: a [MOSIP-based register and W3C verifiable credentials](#). The registrar's own [MOSIP migration reached the end of its pilot and stopped for want of funding](#). Card issuance, the one measure of whether enrolment reaches people, has [no figure published since the under 0.5m recorded for 2024](#).

Payments moved at the front of the stack and not, on the record, beneath it. Four card and wallet products entered service between November 2025 and May 2026, ending with the [Afrimoney prepaid Visa card](#). A re-platforming of the rails themselves is reported to have been contracted in August 2026, but neither the central bank nor the procurement authority publishes an award notice, so the base does not carry it and the row stands unheld. The switch launched in February 2025 has published no volume figure for 2026.

Interoperability advanced from paper to pilot, the Ministry of Finance moving from a [World Bank terms of reference to a data exchange layer piloting on X-Road](#). Geospatial capability was created from nothing, with a [platform launched in July 2026 with Catholic Relief Services](#) and a [national base map begun with JICA in August 2026](#).

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Electronic Transactions Act 2019	In force since 5 December 2019 with no certification authorities, evidence procedures, dispute mechanisms or penalties established (2025-07)	A gap analysis, policy memorandum and implementation roadmap commissioned under the READY Salone project running to 2028; no adoption date for any of the three (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Subscribers Regulations 2025 (SIM-NIN enforcement)	Did not exist; the 2020 Subscribers Identification and Registration Management Regulations were the instrument on file (2025-07)	Operators fined 25,000 new leones per unregistered or pre-activated SIM, with a staged disconnection ladder; the six-month transition clock is presented as running from the announcement, so the phase-out date is unestablished (2026-07)	ADVANCED
National Communications Authority Act 2022	In force, with enforcement powers addressed to licensees (2025-07)	In force and unamended; the analysis finds its powers bind licensees only, leaving foreign platforms outside the perimeter, and identifies s.194 as the route to close the gaps without new primary legislation (2026-07)	NO CHANGE

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Multi-agency response to mobile-money fraud	Did not exist	Three pillars announced - public education, institutional strengthening, better investigation and prosecution - with no new instrument (2026-08)	ADVANCED
National Data Protection Policy	Did not exist	Approved, covering collection, processing, storage and sharing of personal data; the text itself is not published (2026-04)	ADVANCED
National Data Strategy	Updated and aligned to the African Union Data Policy Framework (2025)	No implementation report, institutional owner or review date published since (2026-08)	NO CHANGE

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Sierra Leone-Guinea free roaming agreement	Did not exist	Agreement signed under the Smart Africa single digital market; no commencement date or tariff published (2025-11)	ADVANCED
Liberia-Gambia-Sierra Leone free roaming	In effect, home SIM at local rates across the three countries (2025-05)	In effect; no traffic or price data published (2026-08)	NO CHANGE

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
National open-source software policy for the public sector	Approved as the country's first such policy (2025)	In force; no compliance or adoption reporting published (2026-07)	NO CHANGE

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Data Protection and Right to Access Information Bill	No data-protection statute; a draft Bill in consultation (2025-07)	Cabinet approval given and the Bill to be finalised with the Attorney-General and tabled; not enacted, and no parliamentary date set (2026-04)	ADVANCED
Right to Access Information Commission	Operating under the Right to Access Information Commission Act, access to information only (2025-07)	To be transformed into a single authority for both access to information and data protection, with investigative and enforcement powers; awaiting the Bill (2026-04)	ADVANCED

The governance layer is where the period's movement was thinnest relative to activity. Data protection advanced one stage without reaching the statute book: from a [validated draft in November 2025](#) to [Cabinet approval of a policy and authorisation of a Bill on 21 April 2026](#), with the Bill still to be tabled. Sierra Leone had no data-protection law in force at either end of the window.

The Electronic Transactions Act moved from unimplemented to [being prepared for implementation, through a dialogue of 27-28 July 2026 that is to produce a gap analysis, a policy memorandum and a roadmap](#) with no adoption date. The National Communications Authority Act 2022 and the Cyber Security and Crime Act 2021 both [ended the period in force and unamended](#), tested against a fraud wave they were found not to cover. No rule allocating loss for mobile-money fraud existed at either end.

What did change is enforcement through the register: the [Subscribers Regulations 2025 were announced on 30 July 2026 with a per-SIM penalty of 25,000 new leones and a staged disconnection ladder](#), on a transition clock whose start date is unestablished. Regionally, the [Guinea free-roaming agreement was signed in November 2025](#) with no commencement date published.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
AI-in-government partnership with Qhala	Did not exist	Memorandum to train 500 civil servants and build 10-15 AI workflows; 50+ senior leaders trained by March 2026, no workflow delivery reported (2026-03)	ADVANCED
Deepfake and digital misinformation campaign	Did not exist	Campaign running in Freetown, Makeni, Port Loko, Magburaka, Bo, Kenema and Kono, with broadcast programming and a verification chatbot announced as the next phase; no budget, funder or completion date stated (2026-07)	ADVANCED
National AI Strategy	No AI strategy or readiness assessment on record (2025-07)	First National AI Strategy in drafting with the World Bank, a draft readiness diagnostic produced, and consultations run on local languages and cultural context; not adopted (2026-05)	ADVANCED

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Millennium Challenge Corporation compact dispatch centres and SCADA upgrades	Provided for in the compact, transmission and distribution dispatch centres (2024)	No commissioning, milestone or delivery report published since (2026-08)	NO CHANGE

Artificial intelligence policy went from nothing on record to a drafting programme. The memorandum with Qhala was signed in October 2025 to train 500 civil servants and build 10-15 AI workflows, and a first National AI Strategy entered drafting with the World Bank, with a draft readiness diagnostic produced by May 2026. Neither has produced an adopted instrument or a delivered workflow on the record.

The state's answer to synthetic media was created within the window and is not a rule: a campaign running since May 2026 across seven towns, with no accompanying legislative or platform-facing instrument. The compact-funded dispatch centres and SCADA upgrades report no milestone at either end.

Inclusion and capacity

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Internet penetration	20.7% of the population online, 1.84m users (2025-01)	20.8% online, 1.85m users against 7.02m offline (2025-10)	NO CHANGE
Telecom investment against usage	BASELINE NOT HELD	About US\$400m invested against a 60% usage gap, with 1GB at Le 18,000-25,000, roughly triple the 2018 price (2026-05)	Baseline not held

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Financial inclusion rate	18% of adults (2018)	About 40% of adults (2025)	ADVANCED
Starlink connectivity for universities	12 universities connected, extending to vocational schools (2025-01)	No further site count or extension reported (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
Human intermediation in identity enrolment	BASELINE NOT HELD	Enrolment of the undocumented depends on chiefs, teachers and justices of the peace issuing affidavits that the NCRA accepts at face value (2026-03)	Baseline not held

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Civil service digital skills programme	Did not exist	Running, with 1,000 civil servants in year one and targets of 3,000 medium-term and 5,000 long-term across six areas (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Digital Public Goods university curriculum	Did not exist	More than 1,100 students taught, 14 campus champions across four universities, and 11 student-built solutions evaluated against the DPG Standard (2026-07)	ADVANCED

Skills capacity was built at both the civil-service and university levels, through a [programme launched in July 2026 with 1,000 places in year one](#) and a Digital Public Goods curriculum that has [taught more than 1,100 students](#). Access did not move with them: [12 universities remain the reported extent of Starlink connectivity for the sector](#), and the last penetration figure held is [20.8% in October 2025](#).

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
WARDIP2 regional digital integration operation	Did not exist	Approved across Benin, Liberia and Sierra Leone, targeting 5.2m people connected and digital skills training for 9,000; the Sierra Leone share is not disclosed (2026-03)	ADVANCED
Sierra Leone Innovation Investment Fund	BASELINE NOT HELD	US\$150m over five years stated as a mobilisation target, with no amount raised stated (2026-07)	Baseline not held

External finance was committed and domestic finance was announced within the period. The World Bank Board [approved the US\\$137m WARDIP2 operation on 13 March 2026](#) covering Benin, Liberia and Sierra Leone, with the Sierra Leone share undisclosed; the [Sierra Leone Innovation Investment Fund appeared in July 2026 as a US\\$150m five-year target with no amount raised](#).

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Allocation of loss for mobile-money fraud	Two published analyses disagree on whether the problem is absent law or unenforced law; unreconciled as at 2026-08-09.	not yet probed
Domestic technical capacity to operate the national digital estate	A staffing, skills-audit or operations report from NaTCA, DSTI or the NCRA covering who runs the national systems and with what capacity.	not yet probed
Digitalisation of local councils	A local government digital plan, a council-level service platform, or a district administration report on digital service delivery.	not yet probed
European Union digital cooperation with Sierra Leone	A Global Gateway or EU delegation announcement, a financing agreement, or a programme document naming Sierra Leone.	not yet probed
Indian digital cooperation with Sierra Leone	A bilateral memorandum, a line-of-credit agreement, or an India Stack or ITEC programme document naming Sierra Leone.	not yet probed
Gulf state digital investment in Sierra Leone	An investment agreement, data-centre or connectivity commitment from a Gulf sovereign fund or operator.	not yet probed
Domestic budget appropriations for the digital sector	The Ministry of Finance appropriation act or budget speech showing the votes for MoCTI, NaTCA, DSTI and the NCRA.	not yet probed
NCRA-SLRSA register-to-register data-sharing agreement	The signed agreement or a published summary stating what data classes flow, on what legal basis and with what retention limit.	2026-08-09
Legal basis for data sharing between government registers	A data-sharing instrument, regulation or protocol governing exchanges between the identity register and other agencies.	not yet probed
United States bilateral health agreement and its data-sharing agreement	The memorandum of understanding and the related data-sharing agreement themselves, a signature date, or a Sierra Leonean government statement naming the instrument. The text is withheld rather than unpublished, and is in litigation in the United States District Court for the District of Columbia	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Bank of Sierra Leone RTGS and ACH re-platforming	An award notice from the Bank of Sierra Leone or the National Public Procurement Authority for references 8922483/8922484, naming supplier, value and scope. The only listing found was an inadmissible-origin tender aggregator, retired 2026-08-10; neither contracting authority's procurement page carries a matching entry.	2026-08-10

Nine rows carry no position at either end. Six are subjects the base holds nothing on for Sierra Leone, and three are documents the record points at without containing them. None was probed within this period; each is carried into the next.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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